

SA Junior Chess League
2024 AUSTRALIAN JUNIOR CHESS CHAMPIONSHIP
PROBLEM SOLVING
UNDER 18 ADELAIDE

NAME: _____ DATE OF BIRTH _____

AGE GROUP (Please Circle)

U14 (Born 2010 or after)

U16 (Born 2008 or after)

U18 (Born 2006 or after)

GENDER (Please Circle) BOY GIRL

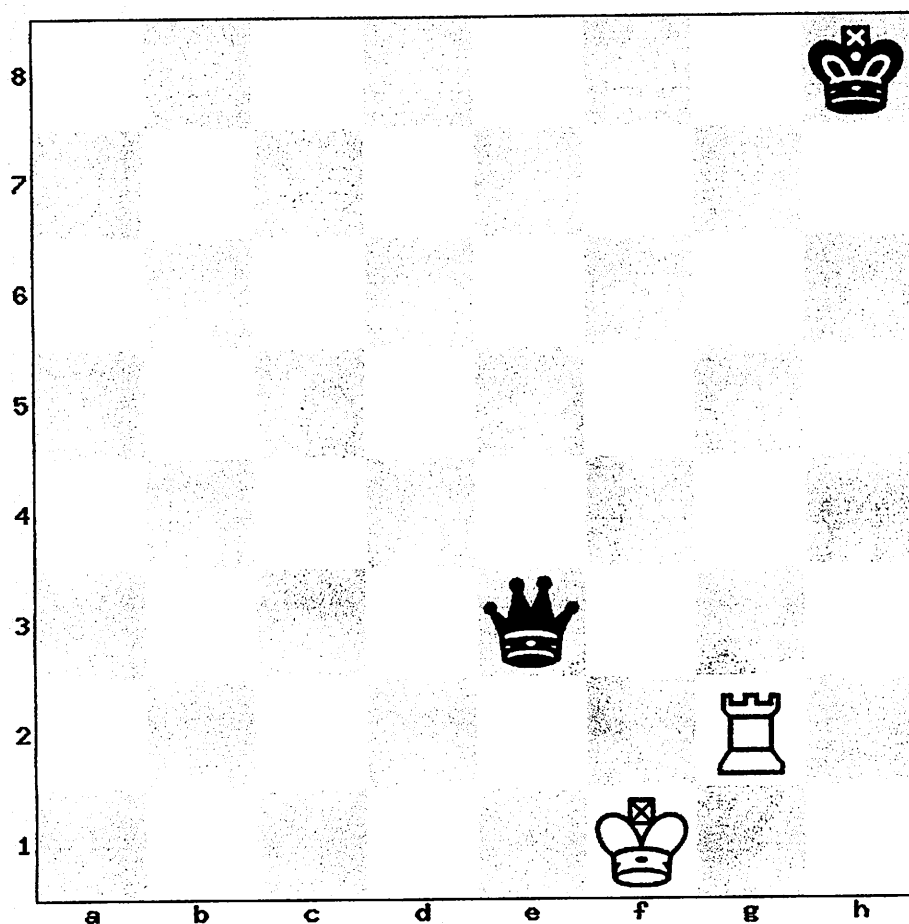
You will have up to **2 HOURS** to complete the problem solving paper. Questions are in order of estimated difficulty, easiest first. You may do them in any order you like but it is recommended that you start at the beginning and work through in approximate order. You may use a chess board and pieces to assist in your work. Solve as many problems as you can, but there is no expectation that you will solve them all. If you do finish all questions before the 2 hours is up, hand in the paper as soon as you are finished so your finish time can be recorded. Times may be used to separate contestants with equal total marks.

Please write your solutions in the space provided below each diagram. Use algebraic notation when writing chess moves. For mate questions, you will receive the maximum marks if you give the correct key move as well as any threats, defensive black moves and responses covering all mates. If the key move does not threaten mate in the stipulated number of moves, write (waiting) after the key move and indicate for each black move the correct white response. If the correct key move only is given you will receive at least 60% of the allocated marks. For game studies, read each question carefully, answer the specific questions asked or go far enough to reach a clearly winning or drawing position as applicable.

Partial answers may receive partial credit. The marks allocated to each question are listed in the paper and total 100.

Question 1

G.Lolli 1763



White to play and draw. Black has a number of ways to terminate perpetual check. Explain how in each case White can still draw. [3 Marks]

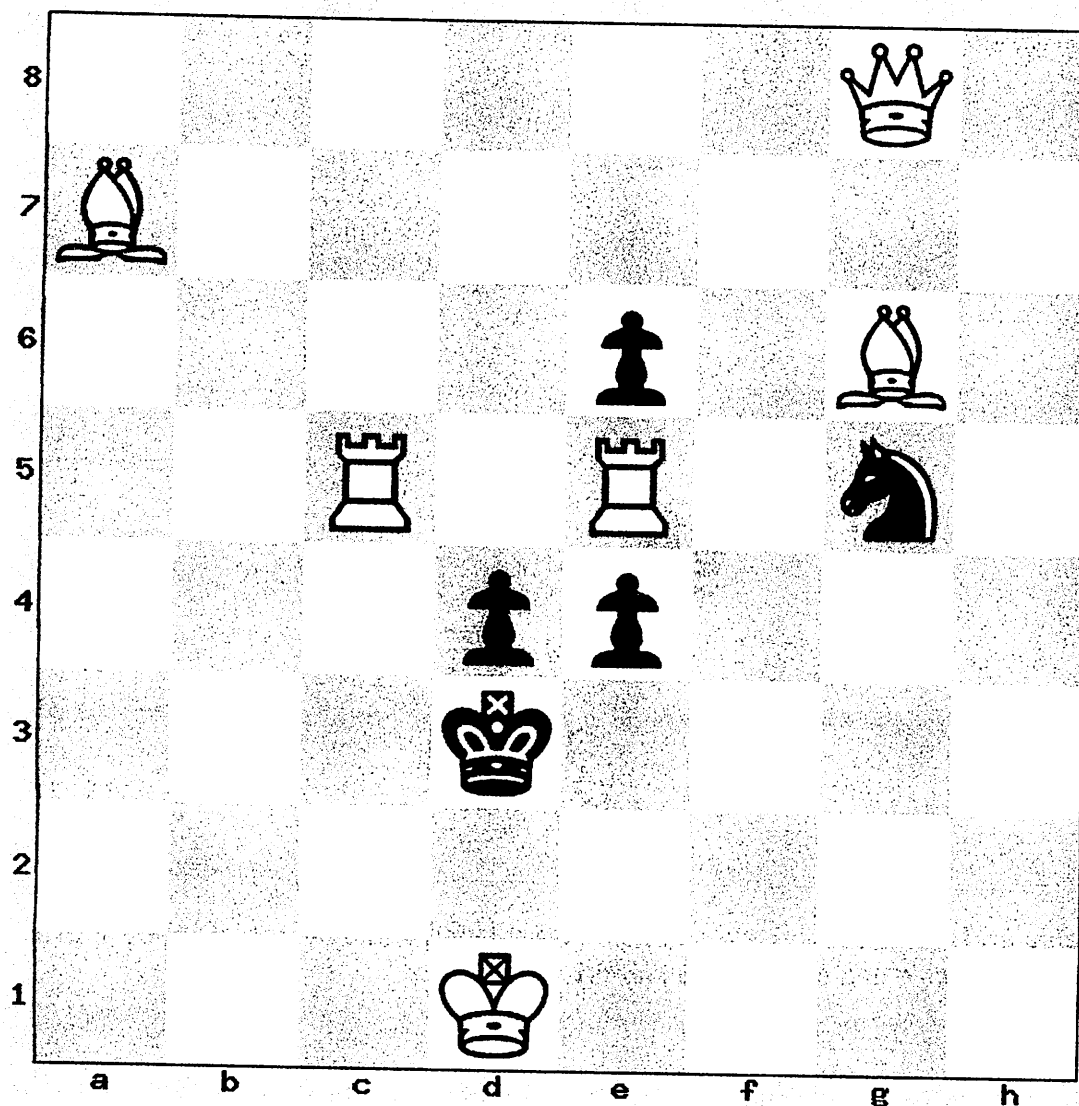
Solution

White starts with **Rh2+** and continues to **check on the file**. If the Black King stays on files f,g and h, a draw by **perpetual check** results. Even if the Black king moves to **h3**, **Rh2+** is still OK because **Kxh2** is **stalemate**. If the Black King moves to f3, **Rg3+ Kxg3** is **stalemate**. If the Black King moves to e file, **Re2 Qxe2 Kxe2** is a draw due to **insufficient mating force**.

Marks...../3

Question 2

Molham Hassan & Andy Sag
Australian Chess 2004



White to play and Mate in 2 [4 Marks]

Solution

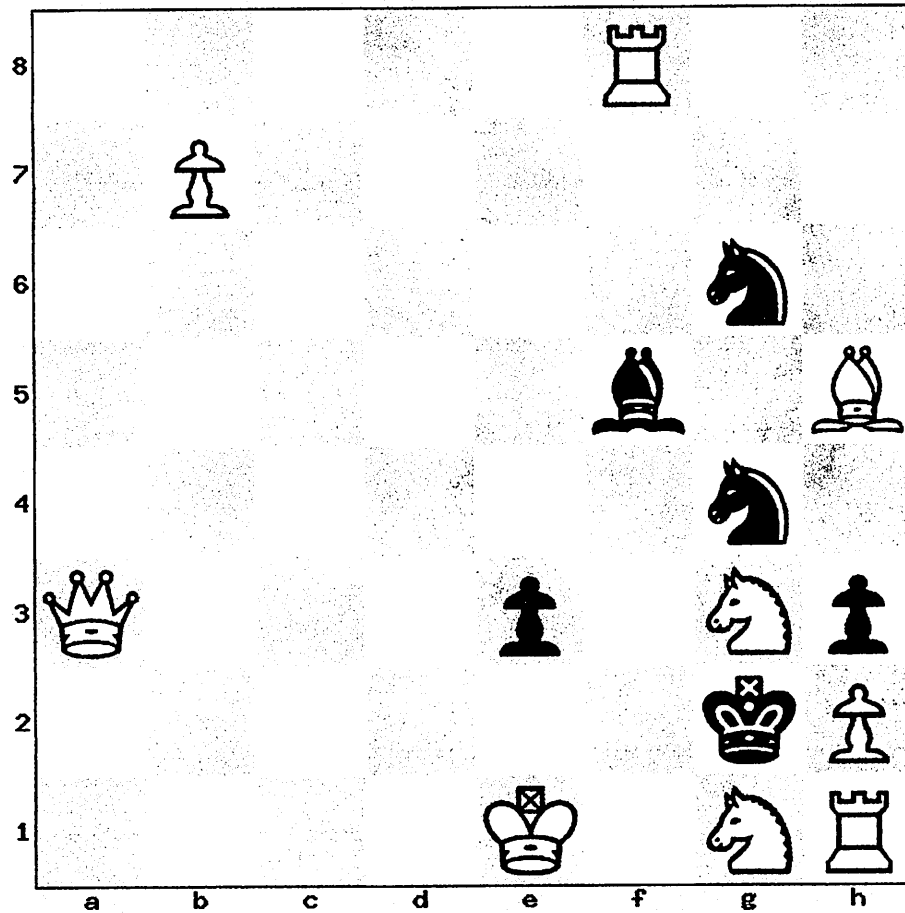
1.Rf5! (waiting). 1...N-any 2.Rf3, 1...Ke3 2.Rc3, 1...e3 2.Rxg5, 1...exf5/e5 2.Qb3.

Marks...../4

Question 3

Andy Sag

Brisbane Sunday Mail 1988



White to play and Mate in 2 [4 Marks]

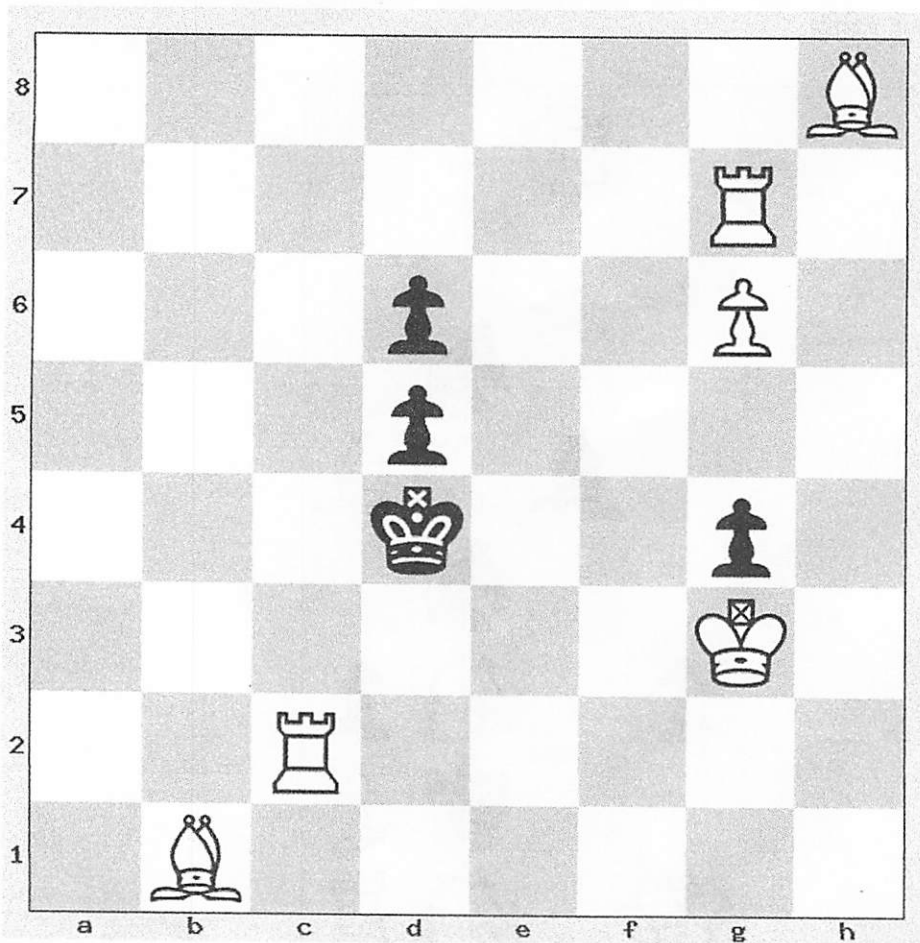
Solution

1.Nf3! (waiting). 1...Kxf3 2.0-0, 1...N6-any 2.Nh4, 1...B-any/N4-any/e2 2.Rg1.

Marks...../4

Question 4

Sam Loyd 1868 (Version)



White to play and Mate in 2 [4 Marks]

Solution

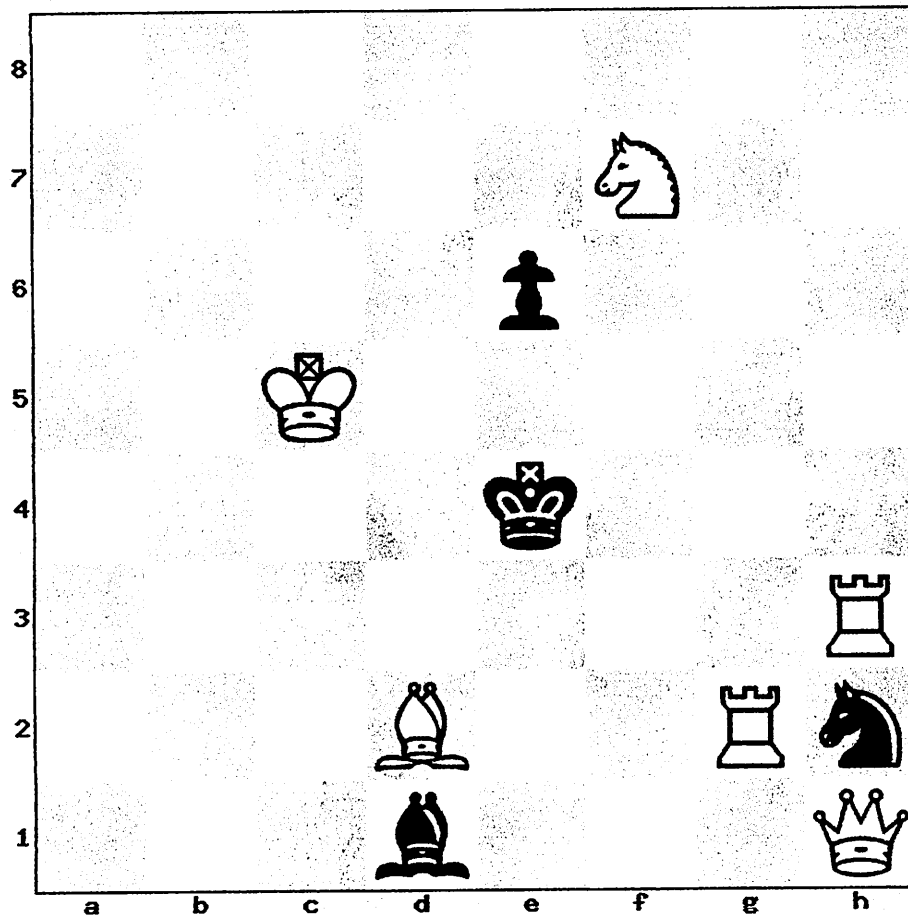
1.Rb2 (Waiting)

1...K moves to e file 2.Re7 1...K moves to c file 2.Rc7

Marks...../4

Question 5

Sam Loyd 1867



White to play and Mate in 2 [5 Marks]

Solution

1.Rf3 (Waiting)

1...Kxf3/e5 2.Ng5 1...Nxf3 2.Qh7 1...Bxf3 2.Qb1

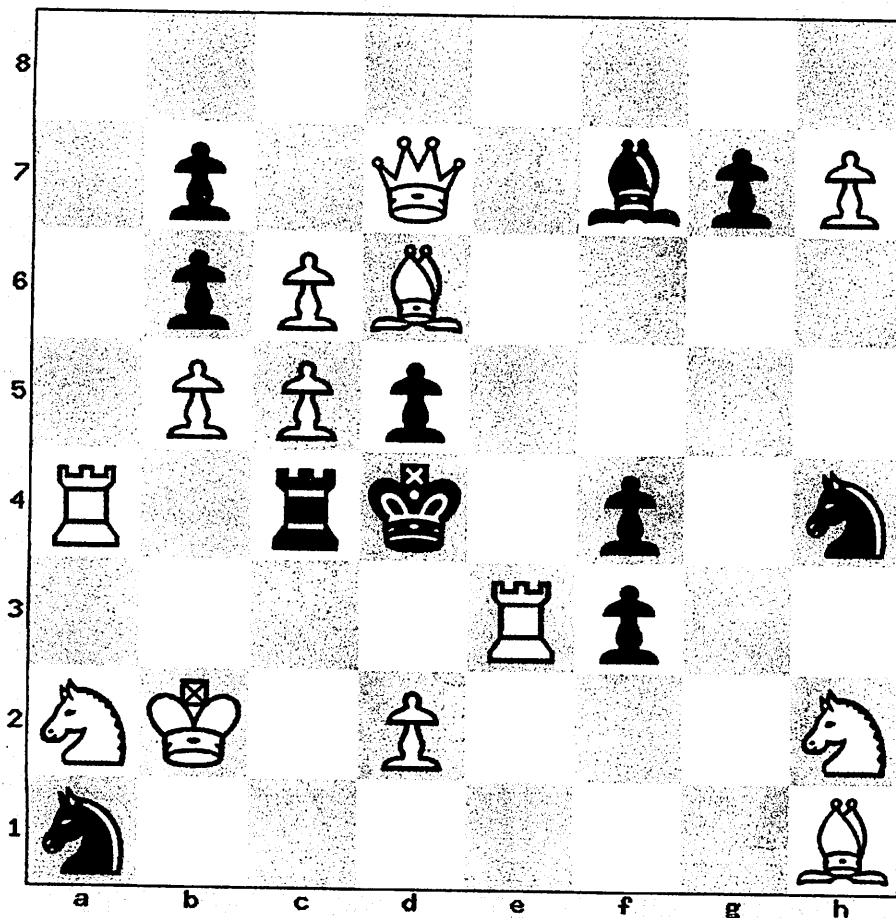
1...B else 2.Re2 1...N else 2.Rg4

Marks...../5

Question 6

Andy Sag

British Chess Magazine 2001



White to play and Mate in 2 [6 Marks]

Solution

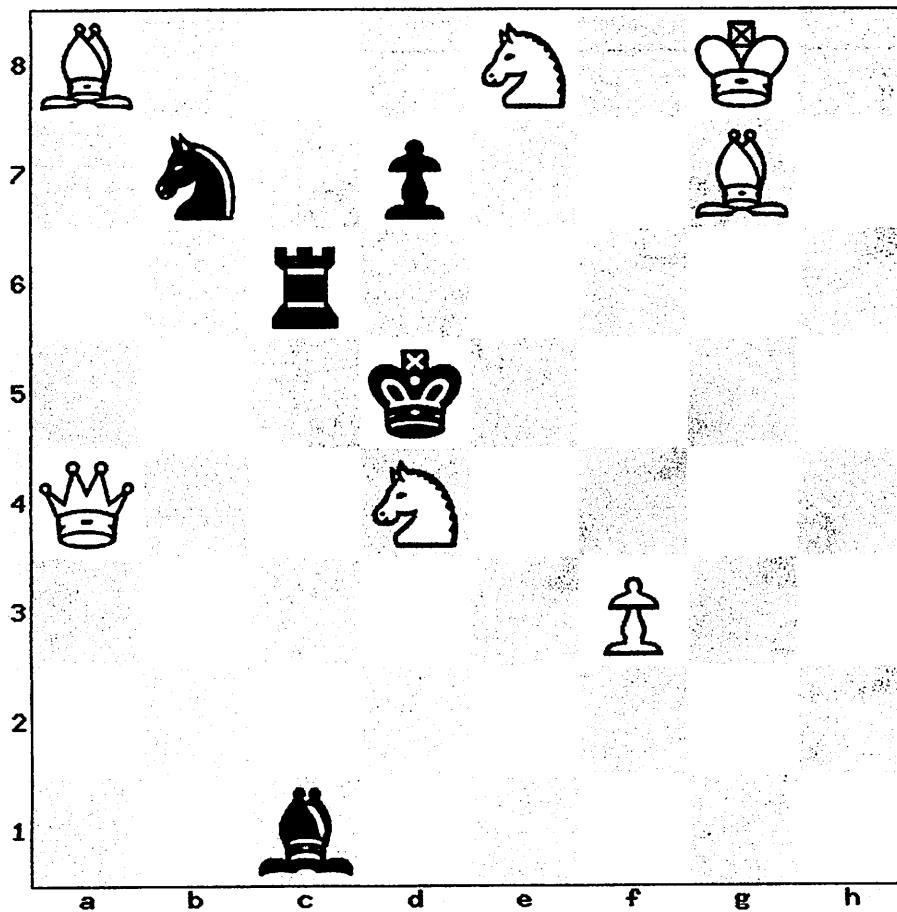
1.Nb4! (waiting). 1...fxe3 2.Qg4, 1...bxc5 2.Be5, 1...Na-any 2.Nc2, 1...Rxb4+ 2.Rxb4, 1...Rc2+ 2.Sxc2, 1...R-else 2.Nc2, 1...Nh-any Nxf3, 1...B-any 2.Qxg7, 1...f2 2.Rd3, 1...bxc6 2.Nxc6, 1...g6/g5 2.h8=Q. Waiter with ten variations including a pin-mate.

Marks...../6

Question 7

Antonio Bottachi

L'Italia Scacchistica 1918, 5th Hon. Mention



White to play and Mate in 2 [7 Marks]

Solution

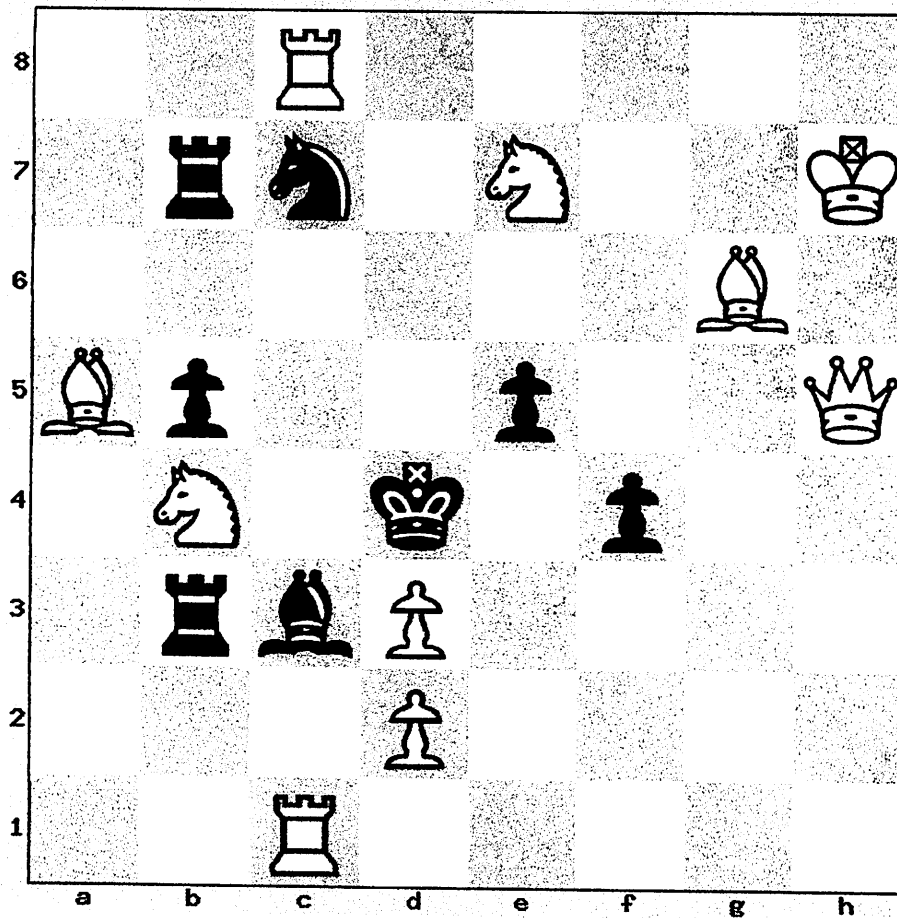
1.Ne6! (2.Qe4) 1...Rxe6 2.Qb5, 1...Rc4 2.Qxd7, 1...Nd6 2.N8c7, 1...Nc5 2.N6c7. 1...dxe6 2.Qd4 Note that if 1.Kxe6 the threat 2.Qe4 still applies but is counted as a variation due to the different king position.

Marks...../7

Question 8

Andy Sag

ACF Bulletin 2003



White to play and Mate in 2 [8 Marks]

Solution

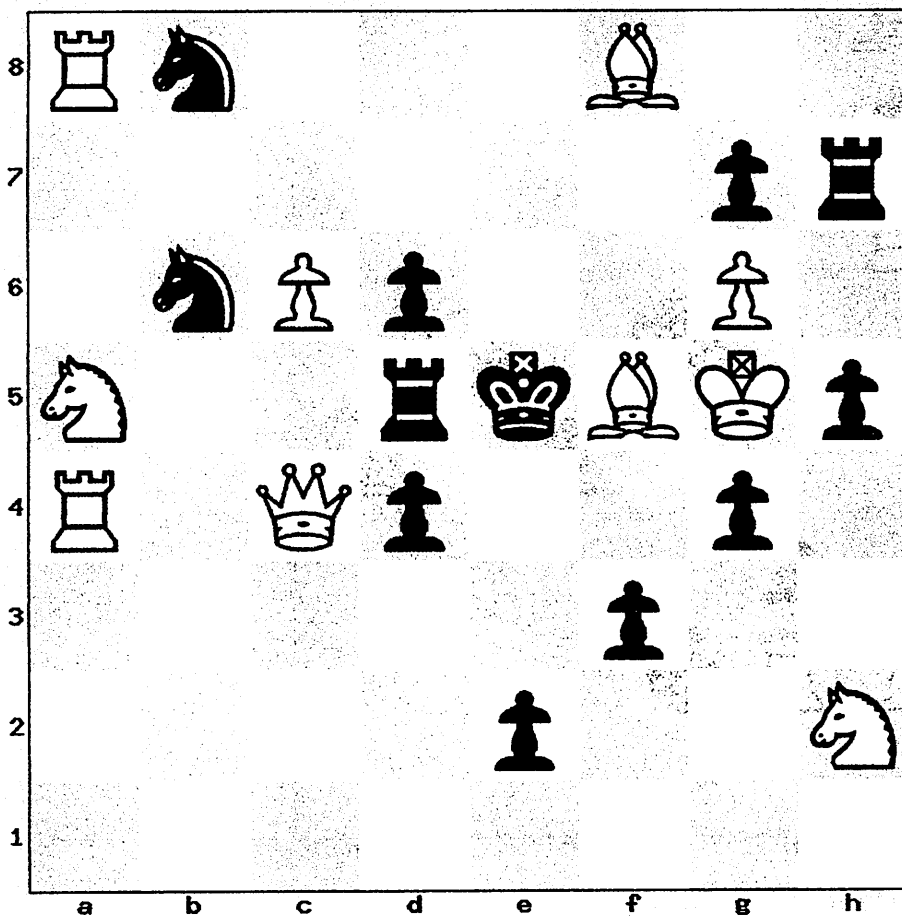
1.Qg5! (2.Qg1). 1...f3 2.Qe3, 1...e4 2.Nec6, 1...Nd5 2.Sc2, 1...Bxd2 2.Nf5, 1...Kc5 2.Qxe5. Threat and five variations.

Marks...../8

Question 9

Andy Sag

The Problemist 1991



White to play and Mate in 2 [9 Marks]

Solution

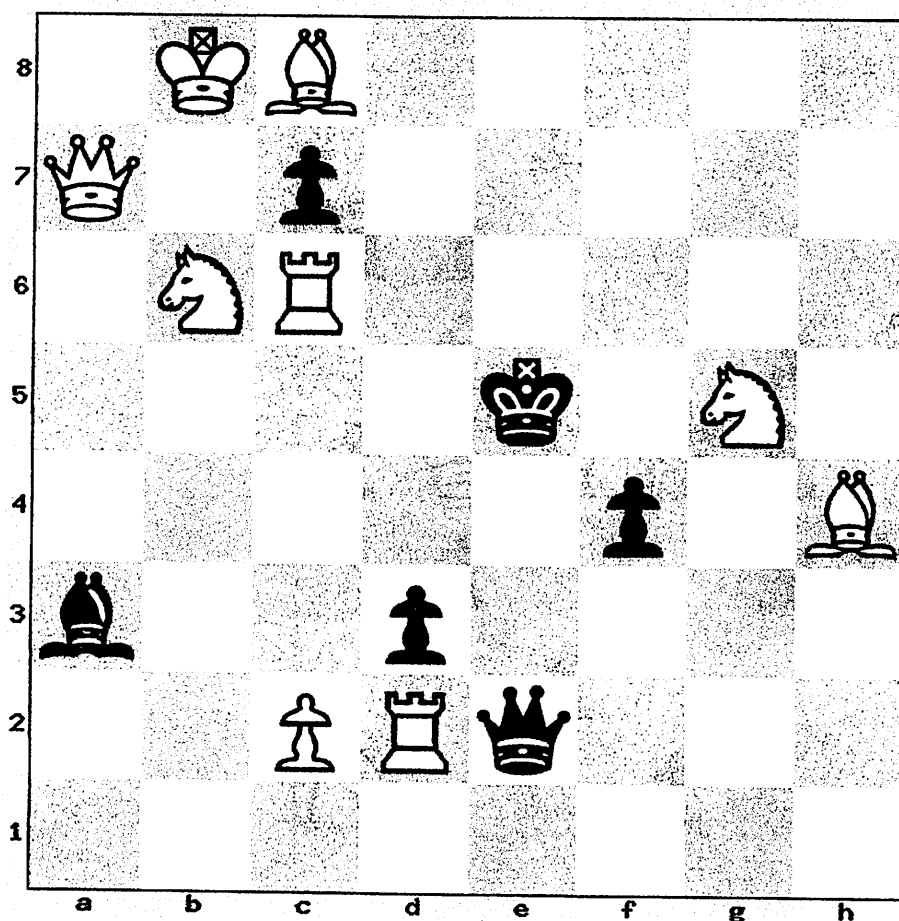
1.Qc3! (waiting). 1...dxc3 2.Re4, 1...Rd-any 2.Qxd4, 1...e1=Q 2.Qxe1, 1...f2 2.Qg3, 1...g3 2.Nxf3, 1...h4 2.Nxg4, 1...Rh-any 2.Bxg7, 1...N6-any 2.Nc4, 1...Nxc6 2.Nxc6, 1...N8-else 2.Re8. Waiter with sacrificial key, ten variations and two changed mates.

Marks...../9

Question 10

Andy Sag

ACF Bulletin 2003



White to play and Mate in 2 [10 Marks]

Solution

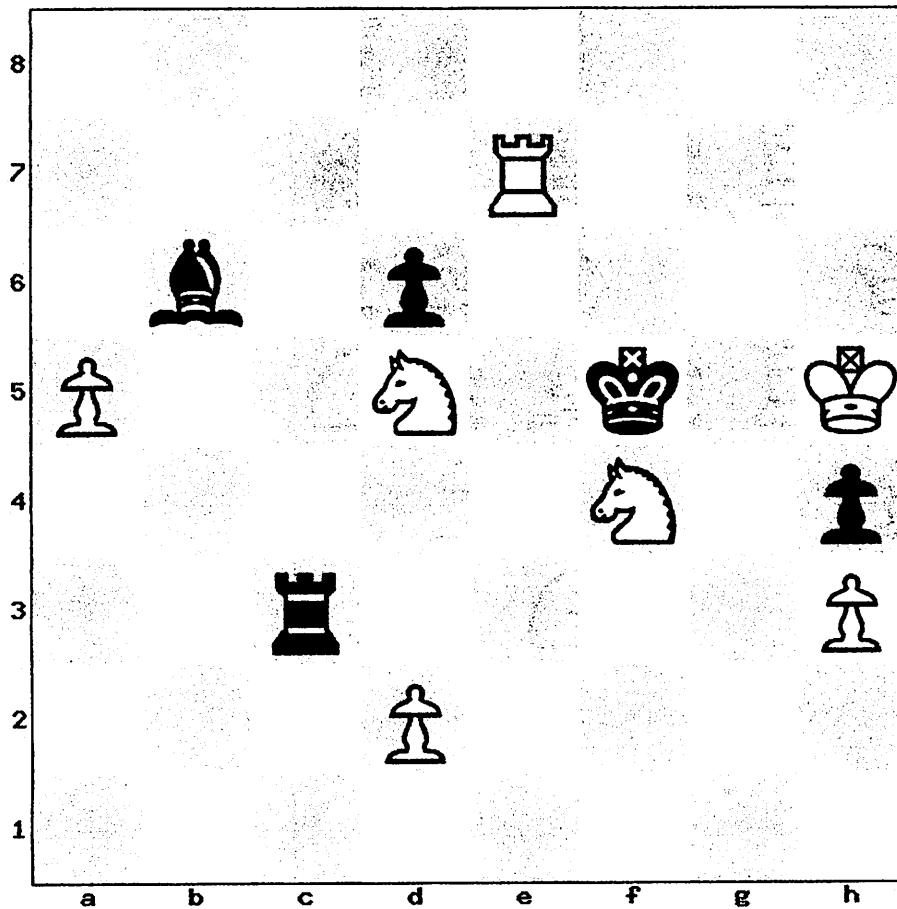
1.Rd6! (2.Nc4). 1...Kxd6 2.Qxc7, 1...cxd6 2.Qg7, 1...cxb6 2.Qe7, 1...Bxd6 2.Qa1, 1...dxc2 2.R2d5, 1...Qe4 2.Sf7, 1...f3 2.Bg3. Threat and seven defensive variations.

Marks...../10

Question 11

Herbert Hultberg

Suomen Shakki 1987-88, 3rd Prize



White to play and Mate in 3 [11 Marks]

Solution

1.Ng2! (2.Nxh4)

1...Bf2 2.dxc3 2...Bg3/Be1 3.Nge3 2...B~else 3.Nxh4.

1...Rxh3 2.axb6 2...R~file 3.Nge3 2...R~rank 3.Nxh4.

1...Rc4 2.d4, 2...Rxd4 3.Nge3 2...Bxd4 3.Nxh4.

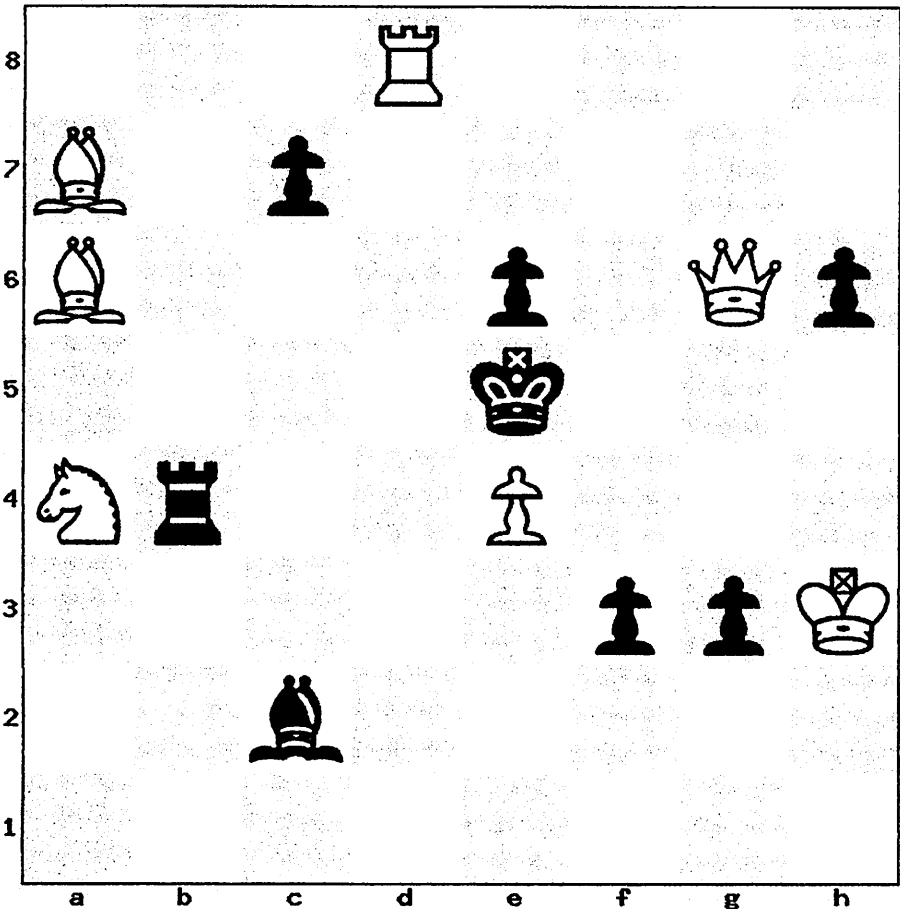
Marks...../11

OzProblems.com 5 Aug. 2023

Question 13

Leonid Makaronez

OzProblems.com 28 Oct. 2023



White to play and Mate in 3 [16 Marks]

Solution

- 1.Bc5! (2.Rd5+ 2...exd5 3.Qf5 2...Kf4 3.Qg4)
1...Bxe4 2.Qxg3+ Kf6/Kf5 3.Rf8
1...Rxe4 2.Qg7+ 2...Kf5 3.Rf8 2...Kf4 3.Rf8/Qf6
1...h5 2.Qg5+ Kxe4 3.Sc3
1...Bb3 2.Qxg3+ 2...Kxe4 3.Bd3 2...Kf6 3.Rf8
1...c6 2.Bd6+ Kd4 3.Bf4. 1...Rd4 2.Bxd4+ Kf4 3.Qg4/Rf8
1...Kf4 2.Qf6+ Kxe4 3.Sc3

Threat and 7 variations.

Try: 1.Kxg3? f2!,

Marks...../16